Saad Iftikhar

Senior QA Engineer

Cottbus, Germany
Email • LinkedIn • Portfolio

PROFILE

ISTQB-certified QA Engineer with 6+ years of experience driving end-to-end quality assurance, test automation, and cross-functional team leadership across mission-critical, financial, and high-traffic media platforms. Proven record of leading QA workstreams, mentoring engineers, and building scalable automation frameworks (Cypress, Selenium, Appium, Playwright) integrated into CI/CD pipelines. Strong background in data validation, ETL/API testing, and Agile delivery. Currently pursuing a Master's in Artificial Intelligence, bringing an analytical, data-driven approach to quality strategy and risk-based testing.

CORE COMPETENCIES

QA Strategy & Leadership • Test Planning & Test Case Design • Manual & Automated Testing • Test Automation Frameworks • CI/CD Integration • Defect & Risk Management • Root Cause Analysis • API & Mobile Testing (iOS/Android) • ETL & Data Validation • Agile/Scrum Delivery • Cross-Functional Stakeholder Management • Team Mentoring & Onboarding • Compliance & Traceability Documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

07/2025 – Present

Quality Assurance Engineer (Working Student) | Axel Springer, Berlin

- Test the BILD and SportBILD iOS and Android apps used daily by millions of readers, safeguarding stability, performance, and release quality.
- Validate APIs with Charles Proxy by intercepting, rewriting, and mapping local calls on mobile devices to verify backend integration.
- Partner with product owners and developers in Jira to refine acceptance criteria and improve backlog quality.
- Onboard and coach new QA team members on tooling, processes, and best practices, documented in Confluence.
- Actively contribute to Agile ceremonies (stand-ups, sprint planning, retrospectives), strengthening collaboration and delivery predictability.

05/2022 – 09/2023

Senior Test Engineer | 10Pearls

- Led QA for a high-risk nuclear plant management platform (web + iOS) used by thousands of workers to capture readings and manage critical operational flows.
- Designed and executed manual and automated tests with Cypress, Appium, and JavaScript across web and mobile, integrated into CI/CD pipelines.
- Authored test strategies and comprehensive test plans in Xray and Confluence to safeguard accuracy in mission-critical, compliance-driven environments.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams from discovery through deployment to ensure compliance and system reliability.
- Mentored junior QA engineers and led onboarding, raising team competence and delivery speed.

03/2021 – 05/2022

Quality Engineer II | S&P Global

- Spearheaded end-to-end ETL testing, monitoring logs in Kibana and analyzing data transformations in Databricks.
- Acted as QA Lead, partnering directly with Product Management and Development leads during iteration planning.
- Wrote complex SQL and PostgreSQL queries for data verification and validation.
- Streamlined testing by building reusable database testing scripts.
- Guided junior team members, establishing quality standards and promoting cross-team collaboration.

11/2019 – 03/2021 **QA Engineer** | Allshore Talent

- Ensured quality for a finance and retirement management platform serving millions of users worldwide.
- Established Cypress/JavaScript automation frameworks and piloted Selenium/Python for scalable web testing.
- Reduced defect leakage through proactive cross-functional defect reviews in Jira and early-stage test involvement.
- Produced detailed traceability documentation, streamlining investigations and supporting compliance needs.

09/2018 – 11/2019 **SQA Engineer** | CareCloud

- Engineered detailed test cases to ensure thorough coverage and product quality.
- Managed the defect lifecycle, providing technical insights to development teams.
- Conducted root cause analysis to prevent recurring issues.
- Produced regular status reports while maintaining testing documentation.
- Served as primary QA contact, championing quality assurance best practices.

EDUCATION

Expected 09/2027 **Master of Science, Artificial Intelligence** | BTU Cottbus–Senftenberg, Germany

Completed **Bachelor of Science, Computer Science** | The University of Lahore, Pakistan

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISTQB Certified Tester – Foundation Level (CTFL).
- Scrum Fundamentals Certified

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages & Querying: Python, JavaScript, SQL, PostgreSQL
- Test Automation: Cypress, Selenium, Playwright, Appium, Postman
- CI/CD & Version Control: Git, GitHub, Azure DevOps, CI/CD Pipelines
- Data & Cloud: Databricks, Apache Kafka, AWS, Azure, ETL, Data Validation, AI/ML Concepts
- Test Management & QA Tools: Jira (JQL), Confluence, Xray, BrowserStack, Charles Proxy, Trace Analysis, Root Cause Analysis
- Soft Skills: Cross-functional collaboration, stakeholder communication, technical documentation, mentoring & coaching

LANGUAGES

English – C2 (Proficient) • German – A1 (Beginner) • Urdu – Native • Pashto – Native

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

- Community Impact Initiative (2023) – Organized a clothing drive supporting 200+ families in need.
- Healthcare Support Program (2023) – Coordinated blood donation campaigns resulting in 150+ donations.
- Technical Education Initiative (2022) – Led a coding competition engaging 100+ university students.